CHAPTER 10

Some Minor Irritations

Well, isn't this embarrassing.

Unfortunately, Compose has a couple of irritating issues. Since you may have encountered them in the preceding chapters, or as you go on to use Compose yourself, it seems irresponsible to ignore them. Here we'll take a quick look at each in turn.

Fortunately, we can work around the first issue—with a little effort. However, the second problem remains elusively unsolved.

Rails tmp/pids/server.pid Not Cleaned Up

For some reason, occasionally upon terminating the app with Compose (pressing Ctrl-C), the Rails server doesn't seem to shut down cleanly, and its server.pid file—which Rails stores in tmp/pids/—isn't deleted. This means that upon starting the app again with:

```
$ docker-compose up
```

you may find yourself confronted by the following error in the output:

```
...
A server is already running. Check /usr/src/app/tmp/pids/server.pid
...
```

The existence of the pid file makes the Rails server starting up believe that there's a server already running, so it won't launch.

Rails saves the server.pid file in tmp/pids. Since we're mounting our local app directory into the container, the file ends up in the tmp/pids/ directory *on our local machine* and is persisted until we delete it.

How do we solve this?